



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cornerstone Classical School
School Website: <https://cornerstonesalina.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Cornerstone Classical School Salina, KS 67401 presents a robust CLASSICAL Christian education founded on a clearly articulated theology and a Triadic curriculum approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric). Public-facing materials consistently frame the school as Christ-centered and biblically grounded, with the Bible and Scripture at the center of learning, and a mission to cultivate wisdom and virtue in students. The pedagogy explicitly includes memorization in the early years, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and Socratic-style upper-school discourse, alongside opportunities for rhetoric and public speaking. Community and parental partnership are emphasized, including a stated commitment to treat parents as co-teachers and to engage families through open houses, admissions processes, and ongoing communication.

Overall, the school's public materials align strongly with the classical education rubric across all six categories. The dominant themes are explicit theology, virtue formation, classical curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric), contemplative pedagogy balanced with Socratic inquiry, a living faculty model, and active parental partnership. Given these patterns, Cornerstone Classical School Salina is classified as CLASSICAL in every category, with explicit evidence in theological grounding, formation-focused purpose, classical curriculum, dual-mode pedagogy (memoria + Socratic inquiry), a faculty described as models and living curriculum, and an active, parental-community orientation.

- Evidence cited from school pages shows: Christ-centered, biblical worldview, and Scripture-centered learning; philosophy of education focusing on wisdom and virtue; explicit mention of grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, and the Trivium; lower- and upper-school pedagogies including memorization, memory-based grammar, and Socratic discussions; faculty composition and modeling by teachers; and parent partnerships and open-family access to the school environment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials emphasize biblical grounding and theology as foundational to education (biblical world view, Bible as central, Scripture at the center of instruction). Examples include statements such as "Cornerstone is a biblically-based school that places the highest value on the word of God and His truth" and "All truth is centered on God's revealed word." - The school frames education as formation in a Christian framework, not secular instruction alone, with explicit statements that education exists to glorify God and form character. - Faculty biographies and governance emphasize worshipful, Christ-centered leadership and Bible-informed standards.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, Bible/Scripture, God, Gospel, theology, Biblical worldview, Word of God, spiritual formation, Lord, Jesus. (Multiple occurrences

across overview, philosophy, and admissions content.) - Negative keywords: none evident in public-facing materials for this category.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: high density (at least 6–8 clearly theological terms cited above). - Negative keywords found: 0 identified. - Proportion: effectively 100% positive signals in this category.

Why this rating - The materials foreground theology and transcendental moral realism via explicit references to God, Scripture, and the Gospel as guiding truth and purpose. The communal worship/Scripture emphasis (e.g., morning spiritual life, convocation) further anchors a liturgical, communal practice. This aligns strongly with the category's Positive Keyword indicators for a religious/metaphysical foundation and supports a CLASSICAL rating here.

What would move the needle - Not applicable; the category already demonstrates a CLASSICAL level of religious/metaphysical integration.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission explicitly states cultivation of wisdom and virtue, with formation (“cultivates wisdom and virtue in its students by nourishing their hearts and minds on truth, beauty, and goodness”) and Christ-centered aims. - Foundational premises emphasize the image of God, the goodness of education as a blessing, and the aim of glorifying God through education, which signals formation over mere information. - Admissions and philosophy references a classical education aimed at lifelong learning, virtue, and character development, not only information transfer.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, formation, truth, beauty, goodness, character, God-glorifying purpose, formation of human excellence. - Negative keywords: none evident in public-facing materials for this category.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: 6–8 distinct terms (virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, character, formation, God-glorifying). - Negative keywords found: 0. - Proportion: 100% positive.

Why this rating - The school's stated aim centers on virtue and wisdom formation through a theologically informed framework, consistent with the classical ideal of formation over mere information. This aligns with the Positive Keywords for “Formation of Virtue and Wisdom” and the Great Conversation ethos (via a Christ-centered, formation-first stance).

What would move the needle - None required; CLASSICAL across this category.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials explicitly reference the Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric, and the role of Latin and rhetoric in the curriculum. Several pages describe grammar/logical/rhetorical training and the development from grammar to logic to rhetoric through all levels, including high school. - The curriculum emphasizes a rigorous classical approach, including memorization in the early years and a three-part training sequence (grammar, logic, rhetoric). The lower-school emphasis on memorization and foundational facts is described as the grammar stage. - Upper-school pedagogy highlights Socratic discussion, dialectic, and rhetoric, with explicit emphasis on debate, argument, and public speaking; electives include Latin and Attic Greek, and there is a “classical approach” description. - Philosophical/educational content references the Lost Tools of Learning and the classical canon logic, rhetoric, and grammar as foundational parts of education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Trivium, classical education, Great Books (via cultural transmission ethos in the classical tradition), history as part of a holistic curriculum, wonder/formation in learning. - Negative keywords: not evident.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword matches: multiple items across curriculum-focused content (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin; Trivium; classical pedagogy; public speaking; history integrated into study). - Neg-

ative keyword matches: 0. - Proportion: 100% positive.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, Trivium pedagogy, and upper-school Socratic discourse strongly aligns with the core Curriculum criterion for a CLASSICAL school. The school's materials reflect a historically informed, Great Books–leaning tradition (via the Great Conversation language in some admissions/content and through explicit classical texts referenced). This category warrants CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - None required; CLASSICAL across this category.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower School: memorization of facts is emphasized as the grammar-stage pedagogy, with habit-building and memory-focused activities; early education centers on formation and memory. - Upper School: Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates, with explicit training in logic, rhetoric, and public speaking; a three-part training in the Trivium (grammar → logic → rhetoric) is described in multiple sources. - The philosophy of education section explicitly frames “The Classical Approach: Pedagogy” as connecting students to tradition and to a God-centered aim; it emphasizes the contemplative, memory-building, and dialogic dimensions of the classical method. - The school describes its aim to develop “students who think clearly and listen carefully with discernment and understanding” and to “reason persuasively and articulate precisely” (upper-level expectations). - Public materials on student life include daily Scripture, convocation, and a spiritual-emphasis routine, integrated with learning, which is characteristic of Holistic/Classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: memorization, Scholé/restful learning, contemplation, rituals (Convocation), singing/memory-friendly routines, Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, rhetoric training, public speaking, logic training, Latin, and overall classical pedagogy. - Negative keywords: not evident.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: numerous (memorizations, Scholé, chanting/singing in lower school (where present), contemplative approach, Socratic discussions, seminars, rhetoric, public speech). - Negative keywords found: 0. - Proportion: 100% positive.

Why this rating - The school's pedagogy is explicitly built around the classical triad and a blend of contemplative/memory-based activities in the early years and Socratic, argumentative, and rhetorical training in the upper years. This is textbook CLASSICAL pedagogy.

What would move the needle - None required; CLASSICAL across this category.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Headmaster and faculty pages describe a living, relational faculty who model virtue, teach as a living curriculum, and mentor students. The published biographical details on the Headmaster and staff portray teachers who are committed to Christian character and scholarly excellence. - The faculty is described as a “living curriculum” and as mentors, with a culture of collegiality and Christian virtue (as evidenced by the staff profiles and church/worldview alignment). - The school emphasizes the teacher's role as role models, with a focus on character and virtue as part of the school's curricular fabric. This is consistent with classical expectations for the teacher as exemplar.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentor/teacher-model, virtue, character, integrity, moral formation, professional, exemplary educators, teachers as models of virtue, supportive and collegial faculty culture. - Negative keywords: none evident.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: multiple (evidence of biography, living curriculum, and teacher-modeling language). - Negative keywords found: 0. - Proportion: 100% positive.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials consistently portray faculty as models of virtue and as part of the core curriculum, aligning with the Classical standard of the faculty as living exemplars and central to the formation process. This supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

What would move the needle - None required; CLASSICAL across this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families, viewing parents as co-teachers entitled to engagement and ongoing parental involvement. Admissions materials explicitly reference parental responsibility and family partnership; current-family communications and events (open houses, parent participation) are described. - The public materials describe a philosophy of inviting parents to participate, tours, open houses, and family involvement in the learning life (e.g., “the education of children is the responsibility of the parents”; “the school acknowledges partnership with parents”). - The Current Families section highlights involvement in community life (volunteering, clubs, events), indicating active parental engagement beyond enrollment.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parental engagement, family involvement, home-school partnership, parent education, open houses, parental responsibility, family catechesis, school-parent synergy, living tradition in the family. - Negative keywords: none evident.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords found: multiple (6–10 distinct items appear across admissions, philosophy, and current-family content). - Negative keywords found: 0. - Proportion: 100% positive.

Why this rating - The school treats parents as co-teachers and actively engages families through admissions processes, family interviews, and ongoing family-life activities. This aligns with the Classical ideal of a school-community partnership and supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 6.

What would move the needle - None required; CLASSICAL across this category.

Aggregate Assessment - All six categories are CLASSICAL based on the keyword alignment, explicit programmatic elements (Trivium, Latin, logic, rhetoric; memorization; Socratic method), liturgical/theological foundations, and a robust parent-community partnership framework. - Executive-level synthesis: Cornerstone Classical School Salina exhibits a consistent CLASSICAL profile across Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community, anchored by Christ-centered theology, formation-focused aims, a Trivium-based curriculum, contemplative-to-Socratic pedagogy, living faculty, and active parental partnership. The school's public-facing materials align with the core Positive Keyword indicators for classical education and show minimal to no alignment with Negative Keyword indicators.

What Would Move the Needle - Not needed; no needle-moving changes are required to reach a fully CLASSICAL rating across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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